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Economic Impact of the Swiss Financial Sector

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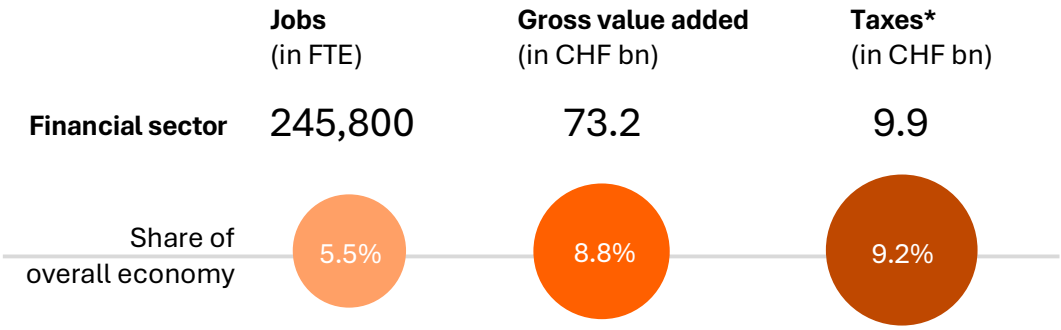
Executive Summary

The financial sector provides a wide range of financial services that go beyond basic domestic services. Internationally significant hubs for cross-border wealth management and reinsurance have established themselves in Switzerland. In 2024, banking services accounted for 14.7 per cent and insurance services for 5.8 per cent of Swiss service exports. The provision of financial services in Switzerland and abroad generated gross value added of CHF 111.9 billion (direct and indirect) along the entire value chain in 2024, associated with 523,700 jobs (FTE).

The financial sector is a backbone of the Swiss economy

The financial sector is essential to the functioning of a modern economy, as it provides basic banking and insurance services to the Swiss population and businesses. In addition to nationally oriented companies, there are also internationally oriented players that export services abroad. These include wealth management and reinsurance in particular. Switzerland has established itself as a location for international hubs in these two segments. In 2024, banking services accounted for 14.7 per cent and insurance services for 5.8 per cent of Swiss service exports, thus contributing to the strengthening of Switzerland's export base.

The provision of financial services to customers in Switzerland and abroad generated direct gross value added of CHF 73.2 billion in 2024, associated with 245,800 jobs (FTE). This means that 5.5 per cent of jobs (FTE) in the Swiss economy are attributable to the financial sector. Due to the above-average productivity of the financial sector, its share of gross value added is significantly higher at 8.8 per cent. Through its economic activity, the financial sector contributes significantly to tax revenue in Switzerland. Through the direct taxation of employee income and profits in the financial sector, the federal government, cantons and municipalities recorded tax revenues of CHF 9.9 billion in 2024, which corresponds to 9.2 per cent of direct taxes on individuals and legal entities.



The direct economic effects of the financial sector in 2024
*refers in the case of taxes to the share of direct taxes of individuals and legal entities.
Source: BAK Economics

The financial sector stimulates economic activity in other industries

Through their demand for intermediate goods and services (including consulting and IT services), companies in the financial sector generate value added in other industries. In addition, retail and commercial enterprises in particular benefit from employee consumer spending. Taking these effects into account, the activities of the financial sector generated total gross value added of CHF 111.9 billion in 2024, either directly or indirectly, and 523,700 jobs (FTE). Taxes levied by the federal government, cantons and municipalities that were directly or indirectly related to the financial sector amounted to an estimated CHF 22.0 billion in 2024, including financial market-related taxes. This corresponds to 13.0 per cent of Switzerland's total fiscal income.

	Direct	Indirect	Total	Overall economy	Share direct	Share total
Jobs (in FTE)	245,800	277,900	523,700	4,467,400	5.5%	11.7%
Gross valued added (in CHF bn)	73.2	38.7	111.9	832.4	8.8%	13.4%
Taxes* (in CHF bn)	9.9	12.1	22.0	169.4	9.2%	13.0%

The direct and indirect economic effects of the financial sector in 2024
Share direct of overall economy refers to the direct effects. Share total of overall economy refers to the sum of direct and indirect effects. Direct and indirect taxes are set in relation to the total fiscal revenues of the Confederation, cantons and municipalities. Direct taxes in relation to the direct taxes of individuals and legal entities.
*The indirect effects of taxes are inclusive of financial market-related taxes.
Source: BAK Economics

Outlook: Above-average growth expected in the financial sector

The tense global economic situation and Trump's tariff policy are having a severe impact on most export industries. The service sector, on the other hand, is developing robustly. Overall economic growth of +1.1 per cent is expected for 2025 (2026: +1.3 per cent).

Despite the challenging global economic environment, the stock market year 2025 has developed positively so far and is providing growth impulse for banks' commission and trading business. In addition, counter-effects to the declines of previous years are expected, partly due to the takeover of Credit Suisse by UBS, with real gross value added expected to grow by +2.3 per cent in 2025 (2026: +1.7 per cent).

The year 2025 will see an above-average level of claims, but at a level that the insurance industry can handle. A sustained increase in insurance volume is expected, which will have a positive impact on the development of real gross value added (2025: +1.8%, 2026: +2.1%).

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